

Declare wildlife as national property

The primary **culprit** behind human-animal **clashes** **is** human-induced **encroachments** and **habitat** destruction

Animal conflicts have been on the rise in many parts of the country in recent times. The main culprit behind this is the human-induced encroachments and destruction of habitats. In the region surrounding the Western Ghats, especially in the Wayanad and Idukki regions in Kerala, there have been **rampant** animal attacks taking human lives in recent times. Every time when there is an attack from wild animals, conflict arises between the forest departments and the public.

Most of the time, the forest department catches the wild animals and **rehabilitates** them in deep forests surrounding the state borders between Tamil Nadu and Karnataka. If the forest department cannot protect either wildlife or human lives, what is the duty of forest officials? **The culprit** of all wildlife attacks **is** human beings themselves. We **often** forget the scientific fact that we are one among the thousands of other animals **inhabiting** this planet and act as if we are superior beings. All our developmental activities and policy decisions are made in an **anthropogenic-centric** manner. In this, we have neither **empathy** nor concern towards our **fellow** species.

This is the root cause of all animal conflicts. Animals often **establish** territories rather than borders in the human sense. These territories serve various purposes, such as **mating**, **foraging**, or defending resources. They may mark these territories through scent marking, **vocalisations**, or physical boundaries like fences or natural landmarks. While these territories may overlap with those of other animals, they're not always fixed or as clearly defined as human borders. Wildlife populations are dynamic and can **fluctuate** based on various factors such as food availability, climate conditions, and predation pressure. **Designating** fixed borders for them **would** not **account for** these **fluctuations** and could **lead to** mismatches between habitat availability and population sizes. **Attempting** to designate fixed borders for them **would** be impractical and not **align** with their natural behaviour.

When they **roam** in the forest, these animals never check whether they have crossed Kerala, Karnataka or Tamil Nadu. Instead of designating borders, conservation efforts focus on preserving and **restoring** habitat connectivity, protecting key wildlife corridors, and implementing measures to **mitigate** human-wildlife conflicts. The whole wildlife area should be protected as national property, and all state forest departments should function **in unison**. There should be frequent interactions between forest officials of neighbouring states for proper tracking of wild animal movements. They should also evolve mechanisms to provide enough food to animals in their range. They can construct **artificial** water reservoirs and food resources inside forests for wild animals to **feed**. When these animals get enough food materials, they may not **venture** into human **dwellings**.

Involving local communities in conservation efforts **fosters** a sense of ownership and responsibility for wildlife protection. It also provides opportunities for alternative **livelihoods**, such as eco-tourism or **sustainable** agriculture, that are **compatible** with wildlife conservation. Protecting and preserving

natural habitats ensures that wildlife populations have sufficient space and resources to **thrive** without direct competition or conflict with humans.

The forest department should also implement early warning systems using technology such as sensor-triggered alarms, camera traps, or drones that can alert forest officials and local communities to the presence of elephants or tigers in the **vicinity**. Over the years, animals have evolved to a level where they know how to **evade** humans' protective measures, like electric fences, **trenches**, or **deterrents** like chilli **smoke**. Only a good **researcher** focusing on animal behaviour **could** evolve mechanisms to tackle this.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

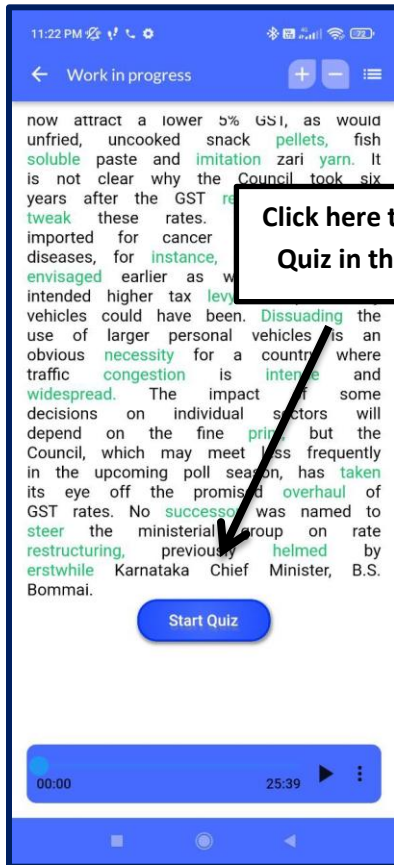
1. **Culprit** (noun) – Accused, offender, perpetrator, criminal, delinquent अपराधी
2. **Clash** (noun) – Conflict, confrontation, collision, encounter, skirmish संघर्ष
3. **Encroachment** (noun) – Invasion, intrusion, trespass, infringement, violation अतिक्रमण
4. **Habitat** (noun) – Environment, natural home, ecosystem, territory, dwelling place आवास
5. **Rampant** (adjective) – Uncontrolled, widespread, unchecked, rampant, excessive अनियंत्रित
6. **Rehabilitate** (verb) – Restore, recover, rejuvenate, renew, revive पुनर्वास करना
7. **Often** (adverb) – Frequently, commonly, regularly, repeatedly, habitually अक्सर
8. **Inhabit** (verb) – Reside in, live in, dwell in, occupy, populate निवास करना
9. **Anthropogenic-centric** (adjective) – Human-centered, anthropocentric, human-focused, man-made, human-induced मानव-केंद्रित
10. **Empathy** (noun) – Compassion, understanding, sympathy, sensitivity, kindness सहानुभूति
11. **Fellow** (adjective) – Similar, akin, equal, like, comparable समान
12. **Establish** (verb) – Set up, institute, found, create, organize स्थापित करना
13. **Mating** (noun) – Breeding, reproduction, pairing, copulation, conjugation समागम
14. **Foraging** (noun) – Search for food, scavenging, rummaging, grazing, browsing भोजन के लिये घूमना
15. **Vocalisation** (noun) – The act of producing sound or voice, especially in animals ध्वनि उत्पन्न करना
16. **Fluctuate** (verb) – Vary, oscillate, swing, shift, alter उतार-चढ़ाव होना
17. **Designating** (adjective) – Appointed, named, selected, identified, chosen नामित करना
18. **Account for** (phrasal verb) – be responsible for के लिये उत्तरदायी होना
19. **Fluctuation** (noun) – Variation, change, oscillation, swing, shift उतार-चढ़ाव
20. **Lead** (to) (verb) – Result in, cause, bring about, produce, provoke कारण बनना
21. **Align** (with) (verb) – Align, adjust, arrange, coordinate, position संरेखित करना
22. **Roam** (verb) – Wander, drift, rove, ramble, meander घूमना

23. **Restore** (verb) – Reestablish, rejuvenate, renew, revive, repair पुनर्स्थापित करना
24. **Mitigate** (verb) – Lessen, alleviate, reduce, diminish, relieve कम करना
25. **In unison** (phrase) – Together, simultaneously, in concert, collectively, as one एक साथ
26. **Artificial** (adjective) – Man-made, synthetic, fake, false, imitation कृत्रिम
27. **Feed** (verb) – Nourish, provide food for, sustain, cater for, support खिलाना
28. **Venture** (into) (verb) – Dare to do something, embark on, undertake, enter, proceed साहस करना
29. **Dwelling** (noun) – Residence, home, abode, habitation, domicile निवास
30. **Foster** (verb) – Encourage, promote, further, cultivate, nurture प्रोत्साहित करना
31. **Livelihood** (noun) – Means of support, subsistence, living, sustenance, income जीविका
32. **Sustainable** (adjective) – Environmentally friendly, renewable, viable, green, eco-friendly टिकाऊ
33. **Compatible** (with) (adjective) – Agreeable, suitable, consistent, congruent, harmonious संगत
34. **Thrive** (verb) – Flourish, prosper, grow vigorously, bloom, succeed फलना-फूलना
35. **Vicinity** (noun) – Proximity, nearby area, surrounding area, neighborhood, vicinity निकटवर्ती क्षेत्र
36. **Evade** (verb) – Avoid, escape, dodge, elude, shirk बचना
37. **Trench** (noun) – Ditch, channel, furrow, groove, trough खाई
38. **Deterrent** (noun) – Obstacle, hindrance, impediment, barrier, discouragement निवारक
39. **Smoke** (noun) – The visible vapor given off by a burning substance, especially the gray, brown, or blackish mixture of gases and suspended carbon particles resulting from the combustion of wood, peat, coal, or other organic matter धुआँ

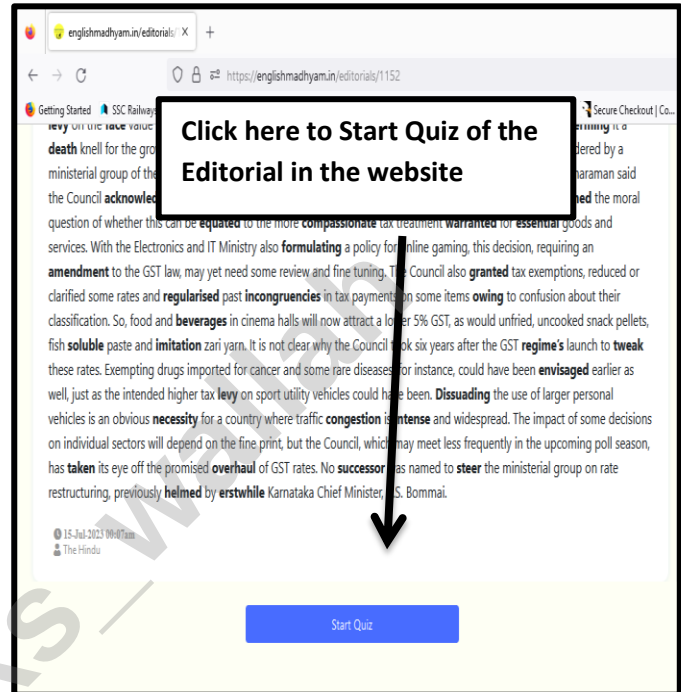
Summary of the Editorial

1. Human-induced encroachments and habitat destruction are the primary culprits behind human-animal conflicts.
2. The Western Ghats, especially in the Wayanad and Idukki regions of Kerala, have seen rampant animal attacks resulting in human casualties.
3. Conflict arises between the forest department and the public whenever there is an attack by wild animals.
4. The forest department often relocates wild animals to deep forests along the state borders between Tamil Nadu and Karnataka.
5. The root cause of wildlife attacks is the anthropocentric approach of humans, who often disregard the needs and rights of other species.
6. Animals establish territories for various purposes, such as mating and foraging, and these territories are not fixed like human borders.
7. Wildlife populations are dynamic, and fixed borders would not account for fluctuations in habitat availability and population sizes.
8. Conservation efforts should focus on preserving habitat connectivity, protecting wildlife corridors, and mitigating human-wildlife conflicts.
9. All state forest departments should work together to protect wildlife areas as national property.
10. Frequent interactions between forest officials of neighboring states are necessary for proper tracking of wild animal movements.
11. Providing enough food and artificial water reservoirs inside forests can reduce the likelihood of animals venturing into human dwellings.
12. Involving local communities in conservation efforts fosters a sense of ownership and responsibility for wildlife protection.
13. Implementing early warning systems using technology can alert forest officials and local communities to the presence of potentially dangerous wildlife.
14. Animals have evolved to evade human protective measures like electric fences, trenches, or deterrents like chilli smoke.
15. Effective solutions to tackle human-animal conflicts require a good understanding of animal behavior and innovative conservation strategies.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



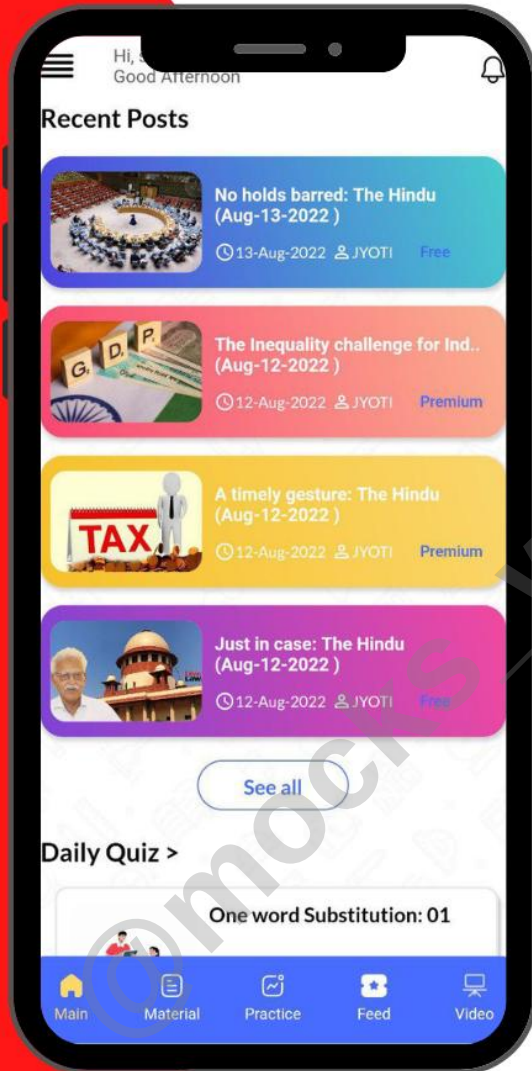
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